

VILE SOULS

Written by
Sany

FIRST DRAFT

A busy coffee shop. People chat and sip their drinks. JOHN, 30s, sits alone at a corner table, staring at his laptop.

SARAH
(cheerfully)
I thought you could use some
company.

SARAH
You've been staring at that screen
for **three hours**.

SARAH
Neither can I.

Sarah and John walk out together, laughing.

A small, cluttered apartment. Books everywhere. Empty coffee cups line the windowsill. John enters, tosses his bag on the couch, and collapses into a chair.

JOHN
(reading aloud)
We need to talk. Tonight.

John sits up slowly.

JOHN
(to himself)
Of course we do.

INT. JOHN'S APARTMENT - LATER

A knock at the door. John opens it. MARCUS, 40s, sharp eyes, expensive coat, stands in the hallway.

MARCUS
You look terrible.

JOHN
Thanks for coming all the way here
to tell me that.

MARCUS
(stepping inside)
We have a problem.

JOHN
We always have a problem. Which
one is it this time?

MARCUS
The kind that doesn't go away if
you ignore it.

John closes the door. Marcus moves to the window and looks out.

MARCUS
They found the files.

A long silence.

JOHN
All of them?

MARCUS
Every last one.

John runs a hand through his hair.

JOHN
How long do we have?

MARCUS
(turning)
That depends on what you're
willing to do.

CUT TO:

INT. UNDERGROUND PARKING GARAGE - NIGHT

Dim fluorescent lights flicker overhead. John and Marcus
walk quickly between rows of parked cars.

MARCUS
There's someone who can help us.
But it's going to cost.

JOHN
How much?

MARCUS
More than money.

John stops walking.

JOHN
Then I'm not interested.

MARCUS
(stopping)
You don't have a choice.

A car engine starts somewhere in the darkness. Both men
freeze.

MARCUS
(whispering)
Don't turn around.

JOHN
(whispering)
Is that them?

MARCUS
(whispering)
Start walking. Slowly.

They resume walking. The engine idles behind them.

CUT TO:

EXT. CITY STREET - CONTINUOUS

John and Marcus emerge from the garage into the cold night air. They split without a word and disappear into the crowd.

INT. DINER - NIGHT

A greasy spoon diner. Mostly empty. Sarah sits in a corner booth, nursing a coffee. John slides in across from her.

SARAH

You're late.

JOHN

I had company.

SARAH

The bad kind?

JOHN

Is there another kind?

Sarah slides a manila envelope across the table.

SARAH

I found what you were looking for.

John opens the envelope and scans the contents. His expression darkens.

JOHN

Where did you get this?

SARAH

Does it matter?

JOHN

It matters a lot.

SARAH

(leaning in)

The question is what you're going to do with it.

A beat.

JOHN
I need more time.

SARAH
Time is the one thing you don't
have.

CUT TO:

INT. ABANDONED WAREHOUSE - NIGHT

A vast, dark space. Water drips somewhere in the shadows.
John enters alone, flashlight in hand.

He sweeps the beam across the room. Empty crates. Broken
glass. A rusted staircase leading up.

A FIGURE steps out of the shadows.

FIGURE
(distorted voice)
You came alone.

JOHN
You asked me to.

FIGURE
Smart man.

The figure steps closer. It's ELENA, 50s, silver hair, cold
eyes.

ELENA
I've been watching you for a long
time, John.

JOHN
I know.

ELENA
Then you know why you're here.

JOHN
I want out.

ELENA
(smiling)
Everyone wants out.

She circles him slowly.

ELENA

The question is what you're
willing to give up.

JOHN

Name your price.

ELENA

The files. All of them. And the
name of whoever helped you get
them.

A long pause.

JOHN

I can get you the files.

ELENA

And the name?

John meets her gaze.

JOHN

I'll need time.

ELENA

You have until sunrise.

CUT TO:

EXT. ROOFTOP - PRE-DAWN

John stands at the edge of the roof, looking out over the
city. Sarah appears behind him.

SARAH

You're not seriously considering
it.

JOHN

I don't see another way.

SARAH

There's always another way.

JOHN

Not this time.

SARAH

You always say that.

The city glitters below them.

JOHN
If this goes wrong--

SARAH
It won't.

JOHN
You don't know that.

SARAH
(quietly)
No. But I know you.

A long silence. The first light of dawn appears on the horizon.

JOHN
Then let's finish this.

FADE OUT.